



DELHI UNIVERSITY REMAINS THE FAVOURITE DESTINATION FOR STUDENTS IN THE CAPITAL

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Set for an infrastructure overhaul, the culture of excellence continues

Seventy-nine colleges spread across the Capital, 14 faculties, 86 departments, about 2,20,000 students and many more walking the 'hallowed' path every year to find a spot. Such are the staggering figures which have added to the Delhi University's (DU) reputation over the years.

DU was established in 1922 as a unitary, teaching and residential university by an Act of the then Central Legislative Assembly. Only three colleges existed then in Delhi—St. Stephen's College, founded in 1881; Hindu College in 1899; and Ramjas College in 1917. The

university had a modest beginning with just three colleges, two faculties (arts and science) and about 750 students.

The university authorities had complained of resources crunch for long but now DU is up for an overhaul with the funding of Rs 1,300 crore for infrastructure projects. "Within three to four years, DU will have new buildings for various departments. We've also inducted 200 new faculty members at the post-graduation level," says Deepak Pental, vice-chancellor.

The research contributions have provided DU with the most number of centres of advanced studies recognised by the UGC. To improve the standards of education, the university introduced teaching assistantships in 2006. Made available to 129 students so far, the assistantships facilitate the pursuit of research and give students exposure in mentoring students of their respective departments. The university has also put up e-resources, and recently a semester system has been introduced. "In DU, concerted efforts are made to deliver desired results. It is the synergy between the faculty, administration and the students which results in the all-round performance," says Vinaykumar Srivastava, principal, Hindu College.

If past laurels weren't enough, DU has also become a partner university to the Erasmus Mundus programme organised by a consortium of 12 European universities and eight Indian universities. To build better industry interaction, a placement cell was created in 2008. Nearly 500 students were offered jobs in 2008-09 and more than 160 students got internships. "We are faltering a bit at the undergraduate level but the gaps can be plugged through course revision, semester system and some more discipline from all the parties," says Pental.

by Rohit Pitthauria



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